

SYNTHETIC APPELLATE DOCKET — NOT FILED — ALL FACTS AND IDENTIFIERS
ARE FICTIONAL

UNITED STATES COURT OF APPEALS FOR THE FOURTH CIRCUIT

MANDATE

Rule 41 issuance

The mandate issues on July 6, 2026, in Leora Benton v. Blue Cedar Compliance, Inc., No. SYN-CA4-26-CV-4101. Judgment was entered June 15. The rehearing period expired June 29 without a petition. Seven calendar days elapsed after that deadline, and the clerk entered an order releasing ordinary mandate. No stay or modifying order remains in effect.

The certified judgment is issued as the mandate of this court. The district court's narrow exclusion of the late Wynn subject is affirmed. The summary judgment and final judgment on the Title VII retaliation claim are vacated, and the case is remanded for proceedings consistent with the panel opinion. Each party bears its own appellate costs. The mandate is effective when issued and restores jurisdiction to the district court for the remanded proceedings.

MANDATE

Materials transmitted

The clerk transmits the June 15, 2026 panel opinion, the certified judgment, the costs direction, and this mandate to the Clerk of the United States District Court for the Eastern District of Virginia. The appellate record remains associated with No. SYN-CA4-26-CV-4101, and the district record remains identified by JA1 through JA262. Nothing in this mandate adds material to the admitted merits record or changes the evidentiary boundary stated in the opinion.

The remand does not direct a verdict for either party. The district court may conduct proceedings consistent with the opinion while leaving credibility and ultimate causation for lawful determination. The appellate clerk shall serve counsel for Benton and Blue Cedar electronically and shall record mandate issued on July 6, 2026.